

057 Make a grapefruit geode

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HRS

Geodes are dull-looking rocks, but crack one open and you'll find sparkling crystals inside. Make a geode by using a grapefruit as the "rock" and a chemical called alum for the crystals.

What you need

- Grapefruit • Spatula
- Foil • Plaster of Paris
- Goggles • Gloves • Alum
- Hot water • Food coloring
- Measuring cup and scales



1 Remove the flesh from half a grapefruit; line the peel with foil. Mix a cupful of plaster in a bowl; follow package instructions.



2 Let the plaster stand until thick, then use the spatula to spread a thick layer over the foil. Put on goggles and gloves.



3 Sprinkle in some alum and let it harden. In a measuring cup, add $\frac{1}{2}$ cup alum and some food coloring to $1\frac{1}{4}$ cups hot water. Stir well and let cool.



4 Fill the grapefruit with the solution. Over the next week, add any leftover solution. Leave your geode to dry into crystals, then remove the grapefruit peel.

058 Make slime

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Pour 1 cup cornstarch into a bowl. Add a few drops of green food coloring to $\frac{1}{2}$ cup of water. Slowly stir into the cornstarch. Add more cornstarch and roll the mixture into a ball. When you stop, it "melts" between your fingers.

Slime becomes sticky and stretchy

